

12.2 Whipple's Index

Whipple's Index is another numerical indicator that can verify the accuracy of age reporting in population data. This represents the impact on the accuracy of 'age' when respondents report an age ending in the digits 0 and 5 during the data collection stage. Based on the value obtained by the Whipple's Index, it indicates the extent of clustering around ages ending in 0 and 5.

According to the value obtained by the Whipple's Index, the accuracy of the data can be shown as follows.

Whipple's Index Value	Level of Accuracy
Less than 105	Highly accurate data
105 – 109.9	Fairly accurate data
110 – 124.9	Approximately accurate data
125 – 174.9	Rough data
175 and over	Very rough data

Table 12.4 : Whipple's Index by Sex, 1981, 2001, 2012 and 2024

Sex	Whipple's Index			
	1981	2001*	2012	2024
Both sexes	118.6	97.0	100.2	99.2
Male	116.7	97.5	100.3	99.1
Female	120.5	96.4	100.0	99.2

* Based on 18 districts only.

In the 2012 Census, the value of Whipple's Index for both sexes was 100.2, and it slightly decreased to 99.2 in the 2024 Census. By sex, the index value in 2012 was 100.0 for females and 100.3 for males, while in 2024 it was 99.2 for females and 99.1 for males. Since these values are very close to 100, they indicate that the concentration of ages ending in digits 0 and 5 is minimal, suggesting a high level of accuracy in age reporting. Overall, both the 2012 and 2024 censuses demonstrate a high level of reliability in age data, with the 2024 Census showing a slightly improved pattern of age reporting.